



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Loudoun Classical School
School Website: <https://loudounclassicalschool.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Loudoun Classical School (Purcellville, VA, 20132) presents essentially no public materials that reveal a classical education orientation. The available crawl content explicitly states that the school closed down at the end of the 2024-2025 school year and provides no substantive information about religious or metaphysical foundations, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, or family/community engagement. In the absence of explicit classical indicators, the SIX ELEMENTS rubric yields an aggregate rating of NOT CLASSICAL across all categories. The public content contains no references to Truth, Goodness, Beauty, Great Books, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Socratic pedagogy, scholé, liturgical practice, or any other hallmark signs of classical education.

Evidence of status and lack of substantive classical content includes the public-facing snippet indicating closure and contact information, with no additional content about mission, curriculum, or community engagement. A nearly identical notice appears in the crawl copy as well.

Key context from the classical-education rubric (used to frame the analysis) comes from the knowledge-base materials on the six elements of classical education (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community) and their Positive/Negative keyword indicators. Those resources identify the kinds of textual signals to look for (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; Great Books; grammar/logic/rhetoric; Socratic dialogue; liturgical practices; partnership with families; and more). When applied to the Loudoun Classical School public materials, there is an absence of such signals. See the Six Essential Elements framework and positive/negative keyword indicators for the rubric, including representative Positive Keywords such as truth, virtue, beauty, theology, liturgy, great conversation, Great Books, and Socratic pedagogy, as well as Negative Keywords signaling non-classical approaches.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No accessible public material indicating transcendentals, theology, liturgy, or communal sacred practices; the site content centers on a logo and closure notice only.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present = 0; Negative keywords present = 0 (no signals in the material to match the lexicon's indicators). The classical lexicon emphasizes truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, etc.—none appear in the public material.
- Why this rating: Absence of any explicit religious/metaphysical signal or liturgical practice in the public materials; thus not aligning with the category's classical signals.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Public content does not articulate formation toward virtue or wisdom, nor a telos oriented to the true/good/beautiful beyond the school's name. Closure notice dominates.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0. No explicit statements about formation, classical paideia, or the pursuit of true/good/beautiful are present.
- Why this rating: No textual indicators of a classical aim beyond the name; no articulation of formation over information, or of virtue/wisdom as aims.
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The crawl content shows only branding/identity text (logo/ seal) and closure, with no curriculum details or Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, or liberal-arts content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0. No mention of liberal arts, grammar/-logic/rhetoric, Great Books, or historical/cultural curriculum.
- Why this rating: Absence of any curriculum signals that align with classical education (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history as a through-line).
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No description of pedagogical approaches (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé, chanting, memory work, or upper□school rhetoric). The public material is limited to branding/closure messaging.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0. No explicit pedagogical signals in the site copy.
- Why this rating: Without any stated teaching methods, there is no basis to classify as classical pedagogy.
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The site content provides no information about faculty, teachers as mentors, or “living curriculum” concepts. The available public material is a closure notice with branding.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0. No teacher profiles or living-curriculum language to evaluate.
- Why this rating: No evidence of a classical faculty model or portraits of teacher-student formation.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No explicit partnership with families, parent formation activities, or open-visit policies described in the public content. The only content concerns closure and branding.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive = 0; Negative = 0. No signals about parental partnership, community programs, or open campus policies.
- Why this rating: Absence of classical-language signals about family involvement or community partnerships.

Aggregate assessment across categories: NOT CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Across all six categories, the publicly available crawl content provides no explicit evidence of classical education indicators (no Great Books, no Trivium pedagogy, no scholé, no liturgical practices, no faculty living-curriculum language, and no parent-community programs). The Positive/Negative Keyword framework from the Six Essential Elements document yields zero positive and zero negative keyword matches in the school's public materials, which strongly supports a NOT CLASSICAL designation in aggregate. The Six Essential Elements' framework frames the signals we look for; in this case, none of those signals appear in the available content.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable for a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation. The current aggregate classification is NOT CLASSICAL, and there is no category where a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal is present to warrant a “needle move.” If the school were to re-emerge with a classical orientation, concrete steps would include (1) declaring a formal religious/metaphysical foundation (transcendental realism, theology, liturgical practice), (2) articulating a clear purpose/goal aligned with virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful, (3) outlining a curriculum centered on grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, history as Western civilization and/or Christian tradition, (4) implementing classical pedagogy (scholé, Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting), (5) establishing a visible faculty profile that models virtue and the living curriculum, and (6) building strong partnerships with parents and the wider classical-education community with transparent visitation and parent-formation opportunities. These would be the needle-moving steps required to shift toward a CLASSICAL orientation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.